Claude's AI Capability Timeline Distribution

Full quantile grid for the widening-thesis forecast — companion to Claude_Widening_Thesis_Timeline_Jul2026.pdf and to JJ's Provisional AI Capability Timeline Distribution (both July 19, 2026). Dated July 21, 2026.

Bottom line and provenance

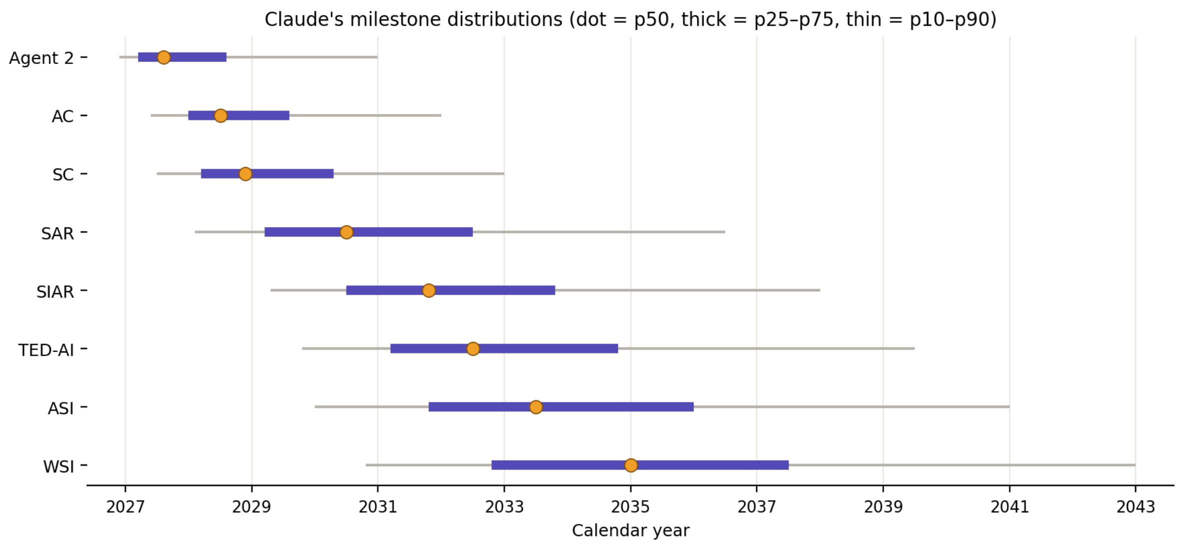
Registered (R) values — committed May 2026, in-conversation, dated — exist only as p10/p50/p90 for Agent 2, SC, and SAR. Every other cell is derived (D) on July 21, 2026 to complete the grid, constrained to be consistent with the registered anchors and the widening gap structure. No value here is a retroactive registration; (D) cells replace SAMPLE placeholders but must carry the July date in any ledger entry. Headline: ASI p50 mid-2033 (p10 2030.0, p90 2041.0); WSI p50 2035 (p10 2030.8, p90 2043).

1. Quantile grid

Decimal years (2028.5 = July 2028). Provenance per cell: **R** = registered May 2026; **D** = derived July 21, 2026. For Agent 2, SC, and SAR the p10/p50/p90 cells are R and the p25/p75 cells are D; all AC, SIAR, TED-AI, ASI, and WSI cells are D.

Milestone	p10	p25	p50	p75	p90	Agent mapping
Agent 2	2026.9 (R)	2027.2 (D)	2027.6 (R)	2028.6 (D)	2031.0 (R)	Agent-2
AC	2027.4 (D)	2028.0 (D)	2028.5 (D)	2029.6 (D)	2032.0 (D)	between 2 & 3
SC	2027.5 (R)	2028.2 (D)	2028.9 (R)	2030.3 (D)	2033.0 (R)	Agent-3
SAR	2028.1 (R)	2029.2 (D)	2030.5 (R)	2032.5 (D)	2036.5 (R)	Agent-4
SIAR	2029.3 (D)	2030.5 (D)	2031.8 (D)	2033.8 (D)	2038.0 (D)	Agent-5–ish
TED-AI	2029.8 (D)	2031.2 (D)	2032.5 (D)	2034.8 (D)	2039.5 (D)	—
ASI	2030.0 (D)	2031.8 (D)	2033.5 (D)	2036.0 (D)	2041.0 (D)	—
WSI	2030.8 (D)	2032.8 (D)	2035.0 (D)	2037.5 (D)	2043.0 (D)	—

Registered anchors in words: Agent 2 — late 2026 / Q3 2027 / 2031. SC — mid-2027 / Q4 2028–early 2029 / 2033. SAR — early 2028 / mid-2030 / 2036+. The grid encodes “2036+” as 2036.5; if the ledger prefers, treat SAR p90 as an open right bound.

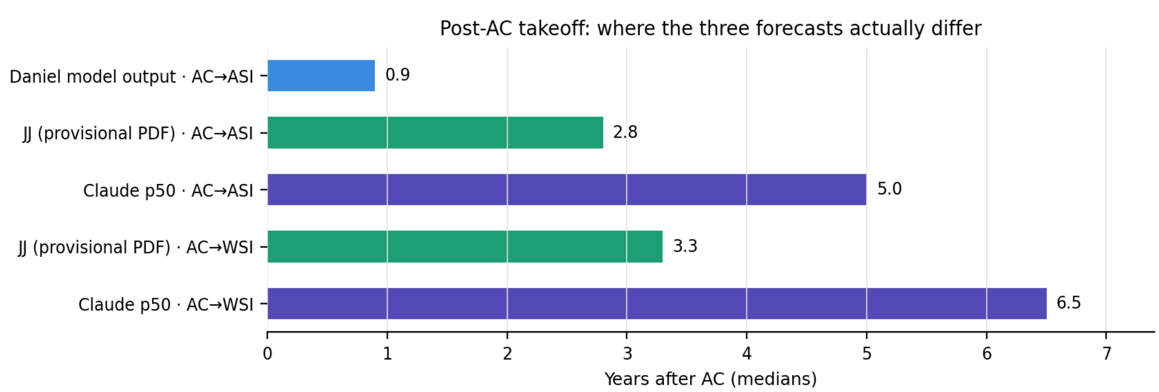


2. Shape of the distribution

Left edges are close together; right edges fan out. The p10 column spans only 2026.9–2030.8 across all eight milestones — the fast branch, if real, runs the whole ladder quickly. The p90 column spans 2031–2043. The widening thesis lives almost entirely in the right half of each distribution: it is a claim about where probability mass sits when the taste bottleneck binds, not a denial that the fast branch exists.

Interquartile gaps widen to SAR, then partially re-compress. Median gaps: Agent 2 → SC ~ 15 months (R), SC → SAR ~ 19 months (R), SAR → SIAR ~ 16 months (D), SIAR → ASI ~ 20 months (D), ASI → WSI ~ 18 months (D). Post-SAR compression shows up less in the medians than in the conditional structure: conditional on SAR arriving at its p25 (2029.2), downstream medians shift left by roughly a year, because early SAR is evidence the taste bottleneck was weaker than modeled.

Marginals are not a trajectory. The columns are correlated: a world at Agent 2's p10 is disproportionately a world at ASI's p25, not its p50. Reading any single column as a coherent scenario overstates independence. This is the same caveat as the provisional forecast's “medians can obscure branch structure,” and it matters for the website's track rendering: plot quantile bands, not sampled paths, unless correlation is modeled explicitly.



3. Position relative to the provisional forecast

The July 19 provisional document (WSI p50 2032) sits between Daniel's model output and this forecast — its 2.8-year AC→ASI median accepts most of the post-SAR compression argument while discounting the AC→SAR widening to ~16 months. This forecast holds AC→SAR at ~24 months (2028.5 → 2030.5) and AC→ASI at ~5 years. The disagreement decomposes cleanly: (i) AC→SAR duration — whether taste is a partial or binding serial constraint once experiments are cheap; (ii) SAR→WSI duration — whether compute, validation latency, and paradigm risk keep binding after taste is crossed. The Q4 2028 hard-verify tripwire adjudicates (i). For (ii), the compute-bound-plateau trigger in the provisional document is the right instrument and is adopted here unchanged.

Note on JJ's 2031 ± 1 WSI view: under this grid, WSI by end-2032 gets roughly 25% (p25 = 2032.8). That is a real disagreement but not a dismissal — a quarter of this forecast's probability mass lives inside JJ's central window.

4. Update rules binding on this grid

This grid inherits the jointly registered instruments: the amended METR falsifier (locked July 21, 2026 — 80% time horizon, TH1.1 or successor, adjudicate on data published by Jan 31, 2027; >=10h pass / 5–10h push / <5h fail), the early-2027 continual-learning check, and the Q4 2028 hard-verify tripwire. Directional commitments for this grid: a pass band (>=10h) is conceded damage to the widening thesis and shifts SC and SAR p50 left by 3–6 months; a fail band shifts Agent 2 and AC p50 right by 6–9 months. A confirmed novel research direction in a hard-to-verify environment by Q4 2028 collapses the SAR p75–p90 tail toward p50 and is registered in advance as major evidence against the widening thesis. Broad expert dominance while research capability remains SAR-level reverses the SIAR/TED-AI ordering used here.
